

BRANDED RESIDENCES

Who keeps the premium

What a brand adds to a home after its fees and running costs, and where branded schemes fall short, with a view from the UAE, Egypt and Saudi Arabia



SIX NUMBERS FROM THIS REPORT

19.7% brand premium on a Dubai home that a 5.5% royalty and a typical service-charge uplift would use up in full (Heirstone analysis)

56% Dubai branded premium for H1 2026 reported by Morgan's International Realty; Knight Frank put it at 88.6% for 2023. Savills' matched estimate was 29% (2020)

0.2% gap between Dubai's average off-plan branded price, AED 3,853 per sq ft, and Knight Frank's Prime Index, AED 3,846 (2025)

5,184 branded units added to Dubai's stock in H1 2026, against 4,648 branded homes sold

3.6x spread between the cheapest and dearest of ten registered Bugatti Residences trades, August and September 2026

13x Cairo's branded pipeline against its completed schemes: 26 against 2 (Savills)

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report uses public sources current at October 2026: listed-company filings, brand and developer disclosures, Dubai Land Department transactions as republished by property portals, government and regulator statements, published research and the press. Every figure is referenced in the exhibit sources and in the notes at the end.

Where we combine published figures into a new one, such as a break-even premium or the change between a launch price and a later trade, the inputs are shown and the result is labelled Heirstone analysis.

Dubai supplies most of the price evidence because it is the only market in the region where branded prices can be followed scheme by scheme.

IN BRIEF

The brand premium is banked at the first sale. The owner holds the part that has to last.

Branded homes do sell for more. For anyone underwriting one, the useful questions are how much of the extra price belongs to the brand, who receives it and whether it is still there when the owner sells. On the public evidence, the brand's share is smaller than the headline numbers suggest, and most of it leaves the scheme at the first sale while the owner pays to keep the name on the building.

1 The headline premium mostly measures location.

Published Dubai premiums run from 88.6% (Knight Frank, 2023) to 56% (Morgan's International Realty, H1 2026), on broad comparisons that include location. Matched to comparable homes, Savills found 29% in 2020; Morgan's found under 10% in villa communities. The average off-plan branded price in H1 2025 sat within 0.2% of Knight Frank's Dubai Prime Index.

2 Below a premium of about 20%, the brand does not pay for itself.

A royalty of 5 to 6% of the sale price takes about a quarter of a 30% premium. Broker compilations put branded towers' service charges at 1.2 to 3.1 times their neighbours'; AED 20 per sq ft a year more, capitalised, costs about AED 308 of value. On our central case these two costs absorb the whole of a 19.7% premium.

3 The developer and the brand are paid at signing. The owner carries the rest.

Of a 30% premium, about 24% goes to the brand as a one-time fee and 76% to the developer, before higher build and sales costs. The owner earns about 1.5% a year on the extra capital and, on our central case, nets about 4.4% against 5.3% for an unbranded home. About 80% of Dubai's branded deals are off-plan first sales.

4 Later trades fall back toward the building and its location.

Ten registered trades at Bugatti Residences in August and September 2026 ranged from AED 3,105 to 11,259 per sq ft, with a median 38% below the AED 9,674 launch record. Armani Beach Residences traded at or just below its launch price two years on. At Bulgari Lighthouse, under 40 homes beside a Bulgari resort, a 2025 penthouse sale was 37% above the 2022 scheme average.

5 Supply is running ahead of proof.

Dubai's branded stock grew 34% in the year to June 2026 while branded sales fell 21%. Four-fifths of its pipeline has no hotel, according to Global Branded Residences. Cairo has 26 branded schemes in the pipeline against 2 completed, and Ras Al Khaimah 24 against none. Licences also end: four of the five licensed hotel-condominium towers we traced in the Americas lost the name within about ten years.

WHAT IT MEANS

Land agencies and regulators should publish branded resale data and require the brand's term, termination rights and service-charge budget to be disclosed at sale.

Developers should underwrite a premium of about 30%, the level found against comparable homes, against the 20% bar, keep schemes small and phase homes to hotel delivery.

Investors and lenders should value on registered trades and net yield, and price the chance that the name comes off.

49

named branded schemes in the Heirstone Branded Residence Register, from Marrakech to Muscat

15

Dubai schemes in our Launch-to-Trade Register, six of them with both an early and a later price point

CHAPTER 1



01

The premium depends on the comparison

A premium measured against the average home includes the location. Only a matched comparison isolates what the brand itself adds.

Every adviser in the sector publishes a brand premium and the figures rarely agree. Savills' 2025 study puts the global average at 33%, with resorts at 39% and both established and emerging cities at 30%. For Dubai, the world's largest branded residence city, figures published for the past three years run from below 10% to 88.6%.

The spread comes from the denominator. Knight Frank's 88.6% for 2023 compared branded homes with the rest of the Dubai market. Morgan's International Realty's 69% for the first half of 2024 compared them with the average regular home. Savills' 29% for 2020 matched each branded

sample to comparable unbranded property in the same market.

Matching matters because branded schemes sit in the best districts. Downtown Dubai has 23 branded developments, Business Bay 21 and Palm Jumeirah 18. Set a Palm Jumeirah branded villa against the city average and most of the gap is the Palm.

This chapter lines up the Dubai figures by method, sets branded prices against the prime market and looks at what matched studies elsewhere find. At a 56% premium a brand can carry almost any fee; at 16%, a normal royalty and service charge take most of the uplift.

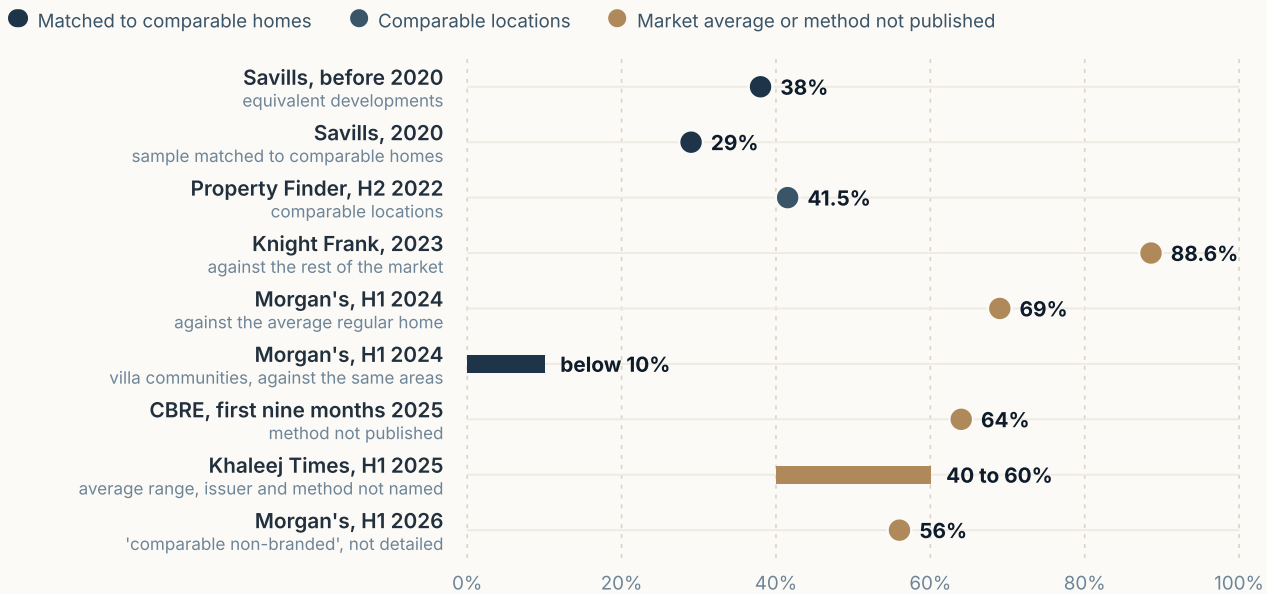
MEASURING THE PREMIUM

Matched against comparable homes, Dubai's premium was 29%. Broader comparisons have put it at 56% to 88.6%.

EXHIBIT 1

The reported Dubai premium depends on what the branded price is compared with

Dubai branded residence price premium as published, by source, period and comparison method



Source: Savills (pre-2020; Oct 2020); Property Finder, Branded Residence Report H2 2022; Knight Frank, Dubai Residential Market Review Winter 2023/24; Morgan's International Realty via Aletihad and Khaleej Times (Aug 2024, Sep 2026); Khaleej Times (Nov 2025, data issuer not named); CBRE, UAE Branded Residences Report 2025 (Dec 2025).

The broader figures have come down, though different firms publish them on different comparisons: 88.6% for 2023 (Knight Frank), 69% for H1 2024 (Morgan's), 64% for the first nine months of 2025 (CBRE) and 56% for H1 2026 (Morgan's). Morgan's attributes the 2026 fall in sales value to smaller units, lower price points and more non-prime stock.

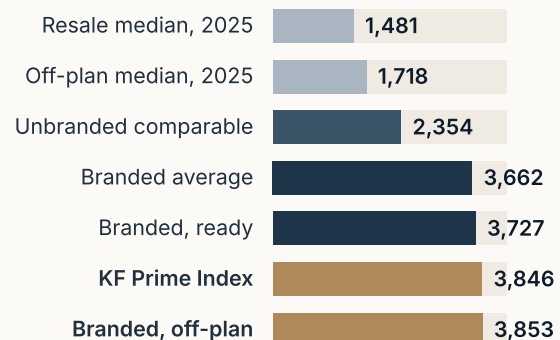
The brand is also reaching further down the market. The average branded sale fell from AED 5.95m in H1 2023 to AED 4.78m in H1 2026 (value divided by transactions, Heirstone analysis). Among the 2023 launches Knight Frank listed, entry prices ran from AED 1.75m at Cavalli Casa Tower to AED 64m at Bulgari Lighthouse.

Against prime stock the premium almost disappears. In H1 2025 off-plan branded homes averaged AED 3,853 per sq ft and ready ones AED 3,727. Knight Frank's Dubai Prime Index stood at AED 3,846 in Q1 2025, 0.2% below the off-plan branded average. The index may include some branded stock, so the comparison is approximate. It still places branded Dubai at the price level of prime Dubai.

EXHIBIT 2

Dubai's average branded price sits on the prime index

AED per sq ft; medians for 2025, averages otherwise; branded figures H1 2025 and H1 2026



Source: fām Properties / DXBinteract (DLD data, 2025); Morgan's International Realty (H1 2025, H1 2026); Knight Frank, Dubai Residential Market Review Q1 2025.

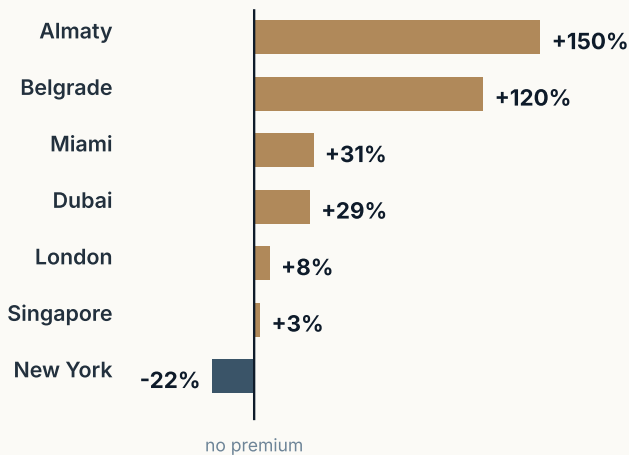
BEYOND DUBAI

Matched premiums run highest where comparable homes are scarcest, and turn negative in New York

EXHIBIT 3

Savills found a premium of 150% in Almaty and a 22% discount in New York

Brand premium against a matched sample of comparable unbranded homes, by city, 2020



Source: Savills, Branded residence price premiums (P. Tostevin), 20 October 2020.

In Savills' 2020 sample, branded homes in New York sold for 22% less than comparable unbranded ones.

Savills' 2020 study is the most complete matched data set we found in the public domain. Its premiums were highest in Almaty (150%) and Belgrade (120%), cities likely to have few modern prime homes to compare against. In London the premium was 8% and in Singapore 3%. In New York, where Savills points to the strength of unbranded super-prime towers, branded homes sold at a 22% discount.

The latest edition finds the same shape. Premiums in emerging cities vary 57% more than in established ones, and Savills warns that weaker projects in emerging markets can underperform local unbranded comparables. A high average premium in a thin market comes with a wide spread around it.

Brand type made less difference than its positioning would suggest. In the 2020 sample, luxury hotel brands achieved the lowest average premium, 16%, against 24% for upscale hotel brands and 25% for non-hotel brands. Two academic studies point the same way. A study of more than 400 UK hotel transactions between 2000 and 2015 found that brand affiliation had no significant effect on hotel values once other factors were controlled. An MIT study of Manhattan condominiums sold between 2004 and 2011 found buyers paid more for branded buildings but placed no value on the hotel amenities in the package.

For the Gulf and Egypt the implication is uncomfortable. The highest premiums will be reported where there is least evidence: in pipeline markets such as Cairo and Ras Al Khaimah, which today resemble Belgrade more than London.

16%

average premium for luxury hotel brands in Savills' 2020 matched sample, the lowest of any brand type

25%

average premium for non-hotel brands (fashion, design, automotive) in the same sample

57%

higher variance of premiums in emerging cities than in established ones (Savills, 2025)

39%

average premium for resort locations, against 30% for cities (Savills, 2025)

CHAPTER 2

02

Paid at signing

A branded home's premium is shared between the brand that licenses its name, the developer that sells the unit and the owner who holds it, and each is paid at a different moment. The brand and the developer collect at the sale, mostly off-plan. The owner collects only if the premium is still there at resale, and in the meantime pays to keep the name on the building.

This chapter follows a Dubai premium through that ledger, adds the owner's running costs and works out how large a premium has to be before the brand adds any value at all.

THE BRAND'S SIDE OF THE LEDGER

Marriott, the largest hotel group in the segment by Savills' project count, had 144 branded residential properties containing 16,253 homes at the end of 2025. Its annual report describes the model plainly: it receives a one-time branding fee as each unit is sold by the third-party developers who build and sell the homes, with little or no Marriott capital at risk.

Those fees are small for the brand. Marriott's residential branding fees fell 10% to USD 72m in 2025, and management told investors they could rise about 40% in 2026. Its co-branded credit card fees were USD 716m, about ten times as much. A Marriott executive has said the group typically takes 5 to 6% of the sale price; Viceroy takes 4 to 5%, and US and Canadian counsel quote ranges of 2 to 6% and 1 to 6%. At 5 to 6%, USD 72m of fees implies USD 1.2bn to 1.4bn of Marriott-branded home sales a year (Heirstone analysis).

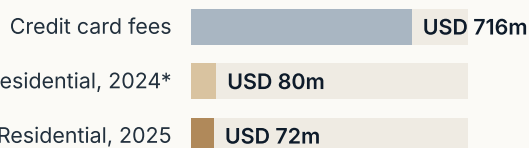
According to a Viceroy executive, brands do not pay key money for residences; the fee comes out of the sale as units sell. For the brand, a scheme is an early, small and nearly riskless payment. For the owner, the name is a cost that lasts as long as it stays on the building.

EXHIBIT 4

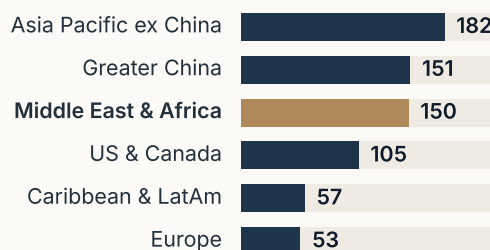
For Marriott, residences are a small fee line spread across large schemes

Marriott International: fee streams, USD m, 2025 (*2024 implied by the reported 10% fall); branded residential homes per property by region, end 2025

Fee streams, 2025



Homes per branded residential property



Source: Marriott International, Q4 2025 earnings call (Feb 2026) and Form 10-K for FY2025 (property table). Heirstone analysis for 2024 fees and homes per property.

THE BRAND DIVIDEND

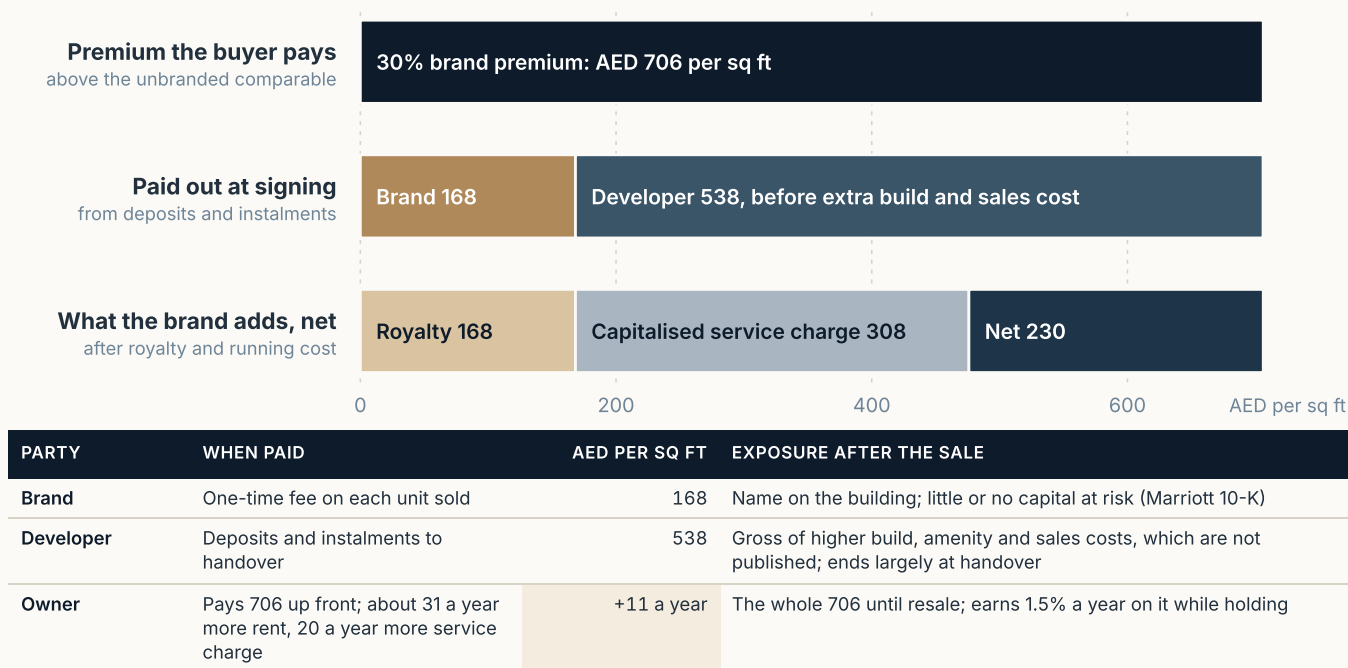
On a 30% premium, AED 168 per sq ft goes to the brand and AED 538 to the developer before the owner has collected anything

We built a ledger for a Dubai home at H1 2026 prices. The unbranded comparable is AED 2,354 per sq ft, the average Morgan's International Realty reports for comparable non-branded homes. We apply a 30% brand premium, Savills' 2025 average for both established and emerging cities and close to the 29% it found for Dubai in 2020 against matched comparable homes, which gives a branded price of AED 3,060. The royalty is 5.5% of the sale price, the midpoint of Marriott's stated 5 to 6%. The service-charge uplift is AED 20 per sq ft a year, the gap broker compilations show between Armani Residences and other homes in Burj Khalifa, and between Downtown's Address and W towers and the district average.

EXHIBIT 5

Who keeps a 30% brand premium

Dubai, AED per sq ft above an unbranded comparable of AED 2,354 (H1 2026); royalty 5.5% of the branded price; service-charge uplift AED 20 a year capitalised at 6.5%



Source: Morgan's International Realty H1 2026 via Khaleej Times; Savills Branded Residences Annual Report 2025/2026 and Oct 2020; Hospitality Investor (Jul 2025, Marriott and Viceroy royalties); broker service-charge compilations (fām Properties Jan 2025; Real Estate Club Dubai Mar 2026; Oliva May 2026); Oliva (May 2026) for gross yields; Marriott Form 10-K FY2025. **Heirstone analysis.** Capitalisation rate is a Heirstone assumption (midpoint of reported unbranded gross yields).

The brand's share is set by the price, not by the premium, so it takes a larger slice of the uplift as the premium shrinks. At 5.5%, the royalty is 15% of a 56% premium, 24% of a 30% premium and 60% of a 10% one (Heirstone analysis).

The developer's AED 538 is a gross figure. Higher specification, amenities and brand-directed marketing come out of it, and none

of these costs is published for any scheme we reviewed. The developer's exposure ends largely at handover.

The owner's position is the residual. After the royalty and the capitalised cost of the higher service charge, the brand adds about AED 230 per sq ft of net value, and only if the next buyer still pays the full 30%, having also priced the higher running cost.

AED 230

net value the brand adds per sq ft on our central case, about 10% of the unbranded price

1.5%

a year earned by the owner on the AED 706 premium, from rent net of extra service charge

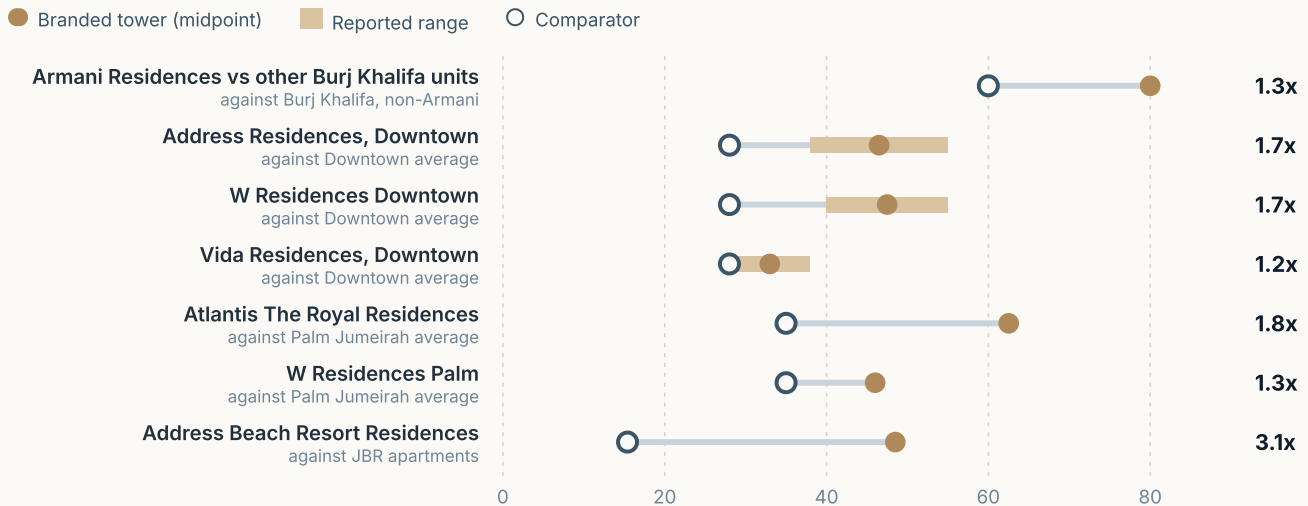
THE OWNER'S CARRY

Broker compilations put branded towers' service charges at 1.2 to 3.1 times those of the buildings around them

EXHIBIT 6

In every compilation we found, branded towers charge at or above their district averages

Annual service charge, AED per sq ft; gold bar shows a reported range, gold dot its midpoint; ring shows the comparator; multiple is midpoint over comparator; branded and comparator figures often come from different brokers



Source: fām Properties (Jan 2025); Real Estate Club Dubai, Dubai Service Charges by Building 2026 (Mar 2026, citing Mollak/RERA); Oliva, Downtown Dubai branded residences explained (May 2026); Christie's International Real Estate Dubai service charges guide (updated Apr 2026). Armani and its Burj Khalifa comparator are both from fām; Address and W Downtown from Oliva, Atlantis, W Palm and Address Beach from Real Estate Club Dubai, against area averages from Real Estate Club Dubai and, for JBR, Christie's. Oliva gives Armani AED 70 to 95, and Burj Khalifa is put at AED 42, 60 or 67.88 depending on the broker. All are broker compilations; the official DLD Service Charge Index could not be queried. **Heirstone analysis** for multiples.

Savills reports that service charges are buyers' first concern in branded schemes. In Dubai the regulator approves building service charges and the Dubai Land Department publishes them through its Service Charge Index, but the index is an interactive tool, and the figures in circulation come from broker compilations that disagree. Three brokers give Burj Khalifa AED 42, 60 and 67.88 per sq ft. The levels differ, but in every compilation we found the branded towers sit at or above their district averages.

Rent does not close the gap. Oliva, a Dubai adviser, reports Downtown branded apartments let on annual tenancies at gross yields of 5.5 to 6.5%, against 6 to 7% for unbranded homes in the same district. On the

midpoints, with service charges of AED 48 and AED 28 per sq ft, a branded unit nets about 4.4% and an unbranded one about 5.3% (Heirstone analysis).

Hotel rental pools change the arithmetic again. In Downtown's hotel-managed pools the operator keeps 30 to 45% of gross rental revenue, according to the same adviser. To leave the owner with the income of an annual let, the pool has to raise gross rent by 43 to 82%, before the higher service charge (Heirstone analysis). In Canada, counsel note that condominium corporations collect monthly amenity fees from owners and pass them to the hotel operator, a further recurring cost outside the purchase price.

4.4%

net yield on a branded Downtown unit against 5.3% for an unbranded one, on reported midpoints (Heirstone analysis)

43-82%

rise in gross rent a hotel pool keeping 30 to 45% must achieve to match an annual let

3

different Burj Khalifa service charges in three broker sources: AED 42, 60 and 67.88

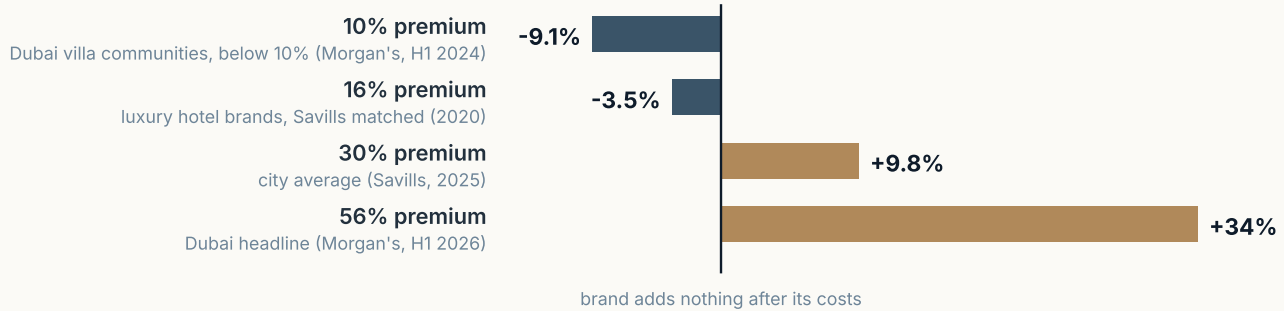
BREAK-EVEN

Below a premium of about 20%, the royalty and the extra running cost absorb the whole uplift

EXHIBIT 7

The brand's net value is negative at premiums of 10% and 16% and positive at 30% and 56%

Net value added by the brand after royalty and capitalised service-charge uplift, % of the unbranded price, at four evidenced premium levels (Dubai prices, H1 2026)



Source: Morgan's International Realty (H1 2024, H1 2026); Savills (Oct 2020; Annual Report 2025/2026); inputs as Exhibit 5. Heirstone analysis. The 56% case includes location and product mix, which the ledger treats as land value.

EXHIBIT 8

The break-even premium ranges from 11% to 27%

Premium at which royalty and capitalised service-charge uplift (AED per sq ft a year) equal the uplift; Dubai comparable AED 2,354; capitalised at 6.5% unless stated

ROYALTY, % OF PRICE	UPLIFT AED 10	UPLIFT AED 20	UPLIFT AED 30
4.0%	11.0%	17.8%	24.6%
5.5%	12.7%	19.7%	26.6%
6.0%	13.3%	20.3%	27.2%
CAPITALISATION RATE, CENTRAL ROYALTY AND UPLIFT			
5.0% / 6.5% / 8.0%	23.8%	19.7%	17.1%

Source: Heirstone analysis. Break-even premium $p = (royalty + c) / (1 - royalty)$, where c is the capitalised uplift divided by the unbranded price.

The break-even premium is the point at which the royalty and the capitalised service-charge uplift use up the whole premium. On our central inputs it is 19.7%. It rises to 27% with a 6% royalty and an AED 30 uplift, and falls to 11% with a 4% royalty and an AED 10 uplift. A lower capitalisation rate, which a buyer of a long-lived prime asset might use, pushes it to 24%.

Set against the evidence, premiums of 29 to 30%, Savills' matched Dubai figure for 2020 and its 2025 city average, clear the bar by about ten points. The 16% Savills found for luxury hotel brands does not, and nor does the sub-10% gap in Dubai's villa communities, where a 5.5% royalty alone takes 60% of the premium. The 56% headline clears it easily, but a buyer paying it is mostly paying for location.

The bar is also the downside. A buyer who pays a 30% premium and sells into a market that pays 10%, the upper bound of the premium Morgan's found in Dubai's villa communities, loses about AED 471 per sq ft, 15% of the price paid (Heirstone analysis).

CHAPTER 3

03

The Heirstone Launch-to-Trade Register

Most branded price evidence in the Gulf is a first sale. We set launch prices against what the same buildings later traded at.

In H1 2026, 82% of Dubai's branded transactions by volume and 78% by value were off-plan, against 69 to 73% for the Dubai market as a whole in 2025, depending on the source. In H2 2022, 61% of branded transactions and 73% of their value were sales by developers. A launch price records what the first buyer agreed to pay on a payment plan. It says little about what the next buyer will pay for a finished home.

The two can move apart in either direction. In H1 2024 off-plan branded homes were about 10% cheaper per sq ft than ready ones. By H1 2025 they were 3.4% dearer, at AED 3,853 against AED 3,727 (Heirstone analysis). New launches were pricing above what delivered branded stock achieved.

Dubai is now the one market in the region where this can be tested. The Dubai Land Department registers each sale, and property portals republish the registered trades building by building. We compiled every named Dubai scheme for which we found an early price point and a later one, and set them against market benchmarks. Outside Dubai we found only two published starting prices, in West Cairo and on Saudi Arabia's Shura Island, and no registered trades.

82%

of Dubai branded transactions were off-plan in H1 2026, by volume

21,918

ready branded homes in Dubai at June 2026, 34% of branded stock

THE REGISTER

Fifteen Dubai branded schemes, from launch to latest trade

AED per sq ft as published by each source, which do not always state the area basis. Launch figures and asking prices are not transaction prices. n/v: not verified in a fetched source. n/c: not comparable (different units or a brand-wide average). Change is Heirstone analysis.

EXHIBIT 9

The Heirstone Launch-to-Trade Register, Dubai, October 2026

SCHEME	BRAND TYPE	HOMES	HOTEL ON SITE	EARLY PRICE POINT	LATER PRICE POINT	CHANGE
SCHEMES WITH AN EARLY AND A LATER PRICE POINT						
Bulgari Lighthouse	Jewellery	<40	Resort on island	9,148 average, H2 2022	12,576 penthouse deal, Jun 2025	+37%
Armani Beach Residences	Fashion	53	No	8,000+ at launch, Jan 2024	7,734 and 8,029, DLD trades, Mar 2026	-3% to +0.4%
Bugatti Residences	Automotive	182	No	9,674 launch record, Nov 2023	3,105 to 11,259; median 5,962 (10 DLD trades, Aug-Sep 2026)	-38% (median)
Four Seasons, Dubai	Hotel	28 / 52	Varies	6,582 scheme average, H2 2022	9,257 brand average, H1 2024	+41% (indicative)
Six Senses Residences, The Palm	Hotel	172	61-room hotel	8,025 off-plan 4-bed, May 2026	4,867 to 7,243 ready resales, Jun to Sep 2026	n/c
Bulgari Resort & Residences	Jewellery	n/v	Yes	6,106 penthouse, Nov 2021	11,380 Bulgari brand average, H1 2024	n/c
SCHEMES WITH ONE PRICE POINT						
Baccarat Residences, Downtown	Design	49	Not stated	14,000 at launch, May 2023	No registered trade found	
Six Senses Residences, Dubai Marina	Hotel	251	No		3,063 to 5,140 (5 DLD off-plan trades, Jan to Apr 2026)	
ORLA Infinity, Dorchester Collection	Hotel	20	Not stated	All 20 sold for AED 1.4bn by Aug 2024	Nearly 10,000 for a 4-bed duplex, 2024	
The Lana, Dorchester Collection	Hotel	n/v	Not stated		8,376 final penthouse, May 2024	
Trump International Hotel & Tower, La Mer	Personal name	n/v	Hotel in scheme	8,351 average, H1 2025	Completion due Q1 2029	
Atlantis The Royal Residences	Hotel	n/v	760-room resort	4,310 or 6,490 (two sources), 2022		conflict
Jumeirah Asora Bay	Hotel	n/v	n/v	3,429 average, H1 2025	AED 350m Ocean Mansion sale, H1 2026	
Ritz-Carlton Residences, Creekside	Hotel	n/v	n/v	3,472, AED 165m villa, H1 2024		
Aman Residences Dubai	Hotel	n/v	Aman hotel		AED 422m and AED 356m sales, H1 2026	
BENCHMARKS						
Dubai branded average				3,853 off-plan / 3,727 ready, H1 2025	3,662, H1 2026	-5% vs off-plan
Comparable non-branded (Morgan's)				2,276 regular homes, H1 2024	2,354, H1 2026	
Dubai, all homes (average)				1,170, 2020	1,866, 2025	+59%
Knight Frank Dubai Prime Index					3,846, Q1 2025 (+17.8% a year)	

Source: Heirstone Launch-to-Trade Register 2026, compiled from Property Finder transaction pages (DLD data, accessed 4 Oct 2026) and Branded Residence Report H2 2022; Morgan's International Realty via Aletihad, Khaleej Times and Arabian Business; Knight Frank (2022, 2023, Q1 2025); Gulf News (Feb 2023, Jun 2025, Mar 2026); The National (Jan 2024); Invest-Gate (Nov 2023); Gulf Construction Online (May 2023); OMNIYAT releases (May 2024, Jan 2025); Luxhabitat Sotheby's (Nov 2021); fām Properties / DXBinteract (2020-2025 averages).

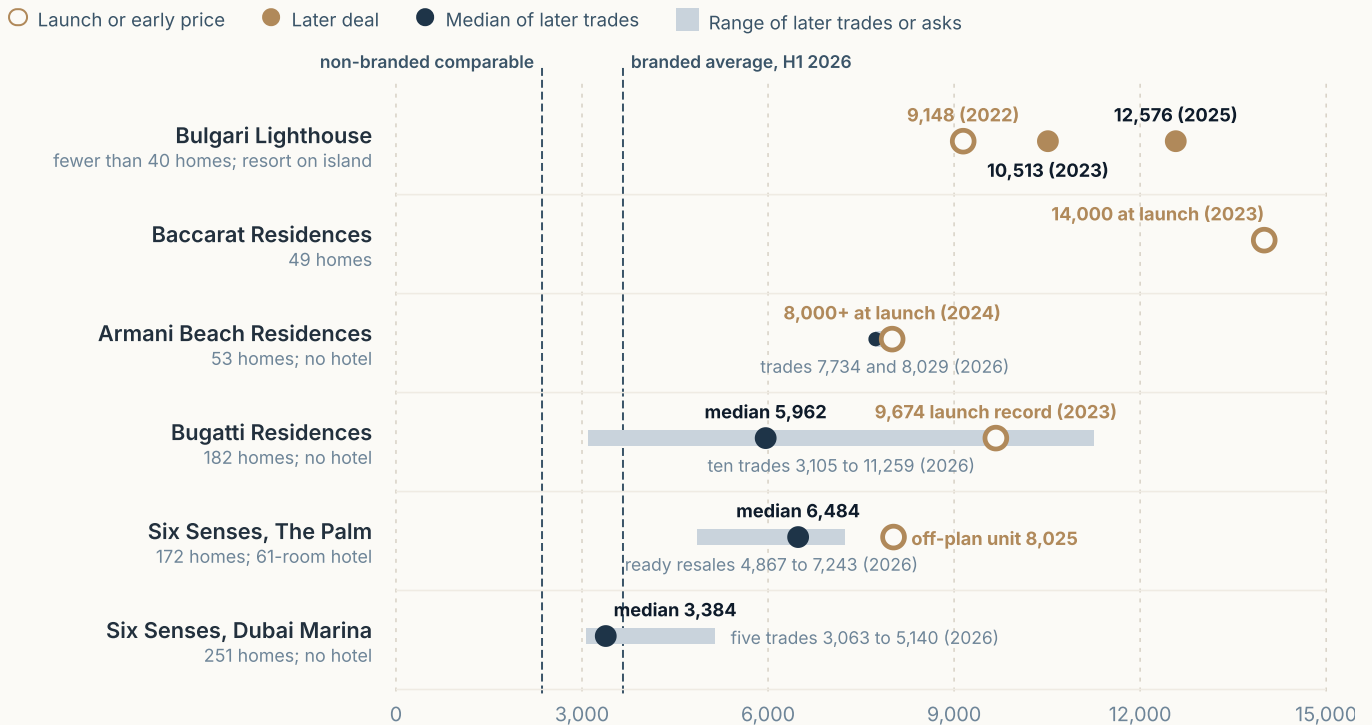
WHAT THE REGISTER SHOWS

A launch record prices the best unit in a building, and most later trades we found sit below it

EXHIBIT 10

Only the smallest resort-anchored scheme has a later deal above its early price

Dubai branded schemes, AED per sq ft, early price points against later trades and asks



Source: Heirstone Launch-to-Trade Register 2026 (Exhibit 9). Bulgari Lighthouse 2022 point is a scheme average and the 2025 point a single penthouse sale; Bulgari Lighthouse 2023 point calculated from a reported AED 410m sale of about 39,000 sq ft (a later report gives 13,543); Six Senses The Palm off-plan point is a single 4-bed unit. Reference lines from Morgan's International Realty, H1 2026.

Bugatti Residences launched in November 2023 at what the developer described as Dubai's highest rate, AED 9,674 per sq ft, and sold its first phase for about AED 1bn. Ten registered trades in August and September 2026, all off-plan and mostly three-bedroom homes, ranged from AED 3,105 to 11,259 per sq ft. Their median, AED 5,962, is 38% below the launch figure, and the dearest trade is 3.6 times the cheapest in the same building (Heirstone analysis). A spread that wide within one building suggests unit attributes matter more than the badge.

Armani Beach Residences launched in January 2024 at "Dh8,000 and above" per sq ft. Two registered trades in March 2026 were at AED 7,734 and 8,029. In 2025 alone, Dubai's median resale price rose 11.3% per sq ft and the off-plan median 6.7%.

Bulgari Lighthouse went the other way. Property Finder recorded the scheme at an average of AED 9,148

per sq ft in H2 2022, and a five-bedroom penthouse sold at AED 12,576 in June 2025, 37% higher, although a penthouse would normally price above a scheme average. The tower has fewer than 40 homes and shares its island with the Bulgari resort. Six Senses at The Palm, with a hotel on site, resold ready homes at AED 4,867 to 7,243; Six Senses in Dubai Marina, with 251 homes and no hotel, traded at AED 3,063 to 5,140.

Two other comparisons are weaker. Morgan's put the Four Seasons brand average at AED 9,257 per sq ft in H1 2024, 41% above the AED 6,582 Property Finder recorded for Four Seasons in H2 2022, but the later figure averages more than one scheme. For Atlantis The Royal Residences, Knight Frank and Property Finder gave 2022 averages of AED 4,310 and 6,490, a gap that shows how much depends on which units a source captures.

CHAPTER 4

04

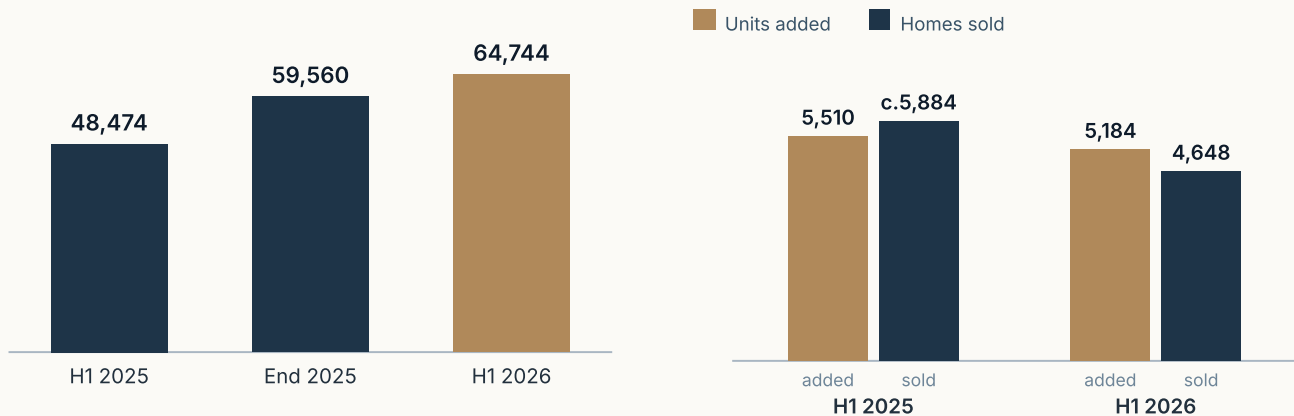
Where the
premium leaks

Supply, scale, the move away from hotels and the limits of a licence each erode the premium after the first sale.

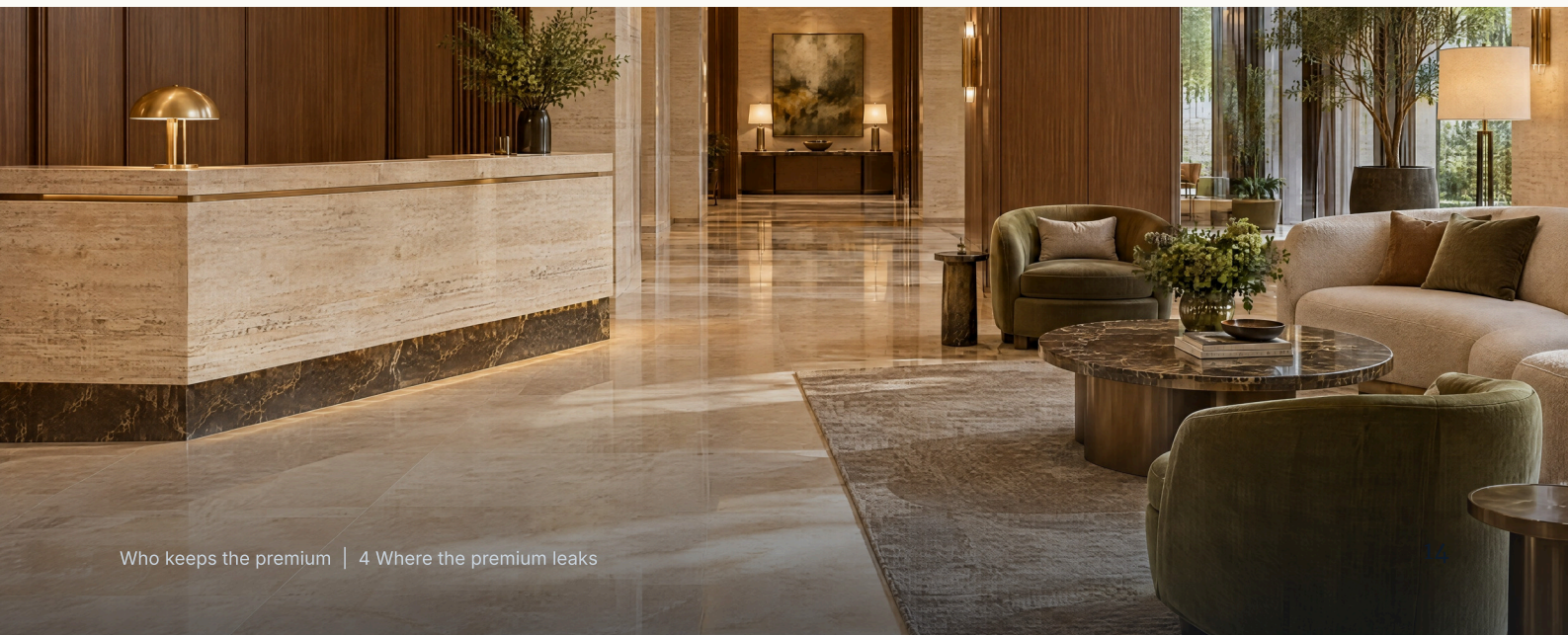
EXHIBIT 11

Dubai branded stock rose 34% in a year, and in H1 2026 the city added more branded units than it sold

Left: branded residential units, completed and under construction. Right: branded units added to stock and branded homes sold, by half-year



Source: Morgan's International Realty, Dubai Branded Residences Reports H1 2025 and H1 2026, via Arabian Business and Khaleej Times. H1 2025 sales implied from the reported 21% fall (Heirstone analysis).



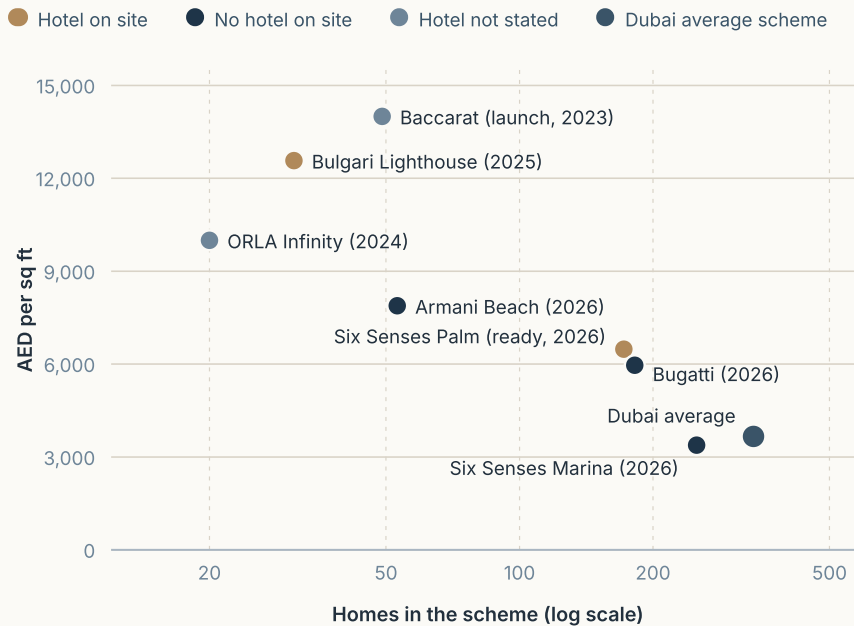
SCALE AND THE HOTEL

The highest prices in the register came from schemes of fewer than 60 homes, against a Dubai average of 337 in H1 2025

EXHIBIT 12

The highest prices come from the smallest schemes

Dubai branded schemes: homes in the scheme against AED per sq ft (latest deal, median trade or launch, as labelled)



Source: Heirstone Launch-to-Trade Register 2026; Morgan's International Realty (H1 2025 stock, H1 2026 price). Bulgari Lighthouse plotted at 31 homes (Knight Frank 2023 launch list; another source gives fewer than 40). Heirstone analysis.

The schemes at the top of the register are small. ORLA Infinity, Dorchester Collection's Palm Jumeirah building, sold all 20 duplexes for AED 1.4bn by August 2024. Bulgari Lighthouse has fewer than 40 homes, Baccarat Residences 49 and Armani Beach Residences 53 at launch. A record also needs very few buyers: OMNIYAT, developer of ORLA Infinity, says it took 37% of Dubai's USD 10m-plus apartment deals in 2024.

The pipeline is moving away from the hotel. According to Global Branded Residences, standalone schemes are a third of Dubai's completed branded projects and 80% of its pipeline. The premium evidence was earned mostly in hotel-integrated schemes, so the pipeline is a different and largely untested product.

Brands are multiplying too. Savills counted 58 brands entering residential in one year. Mandarin Oriental has announced 811 MENA homes against 156 open, and Marriott had 175 branded residential locations in its pipeline against 149 open at the end of 2025.

337

homes per branded development in Dubai, H1 2025 (Heirstone analysis)

c.460

homes per scheme among the 12 branded launches of H1 2025

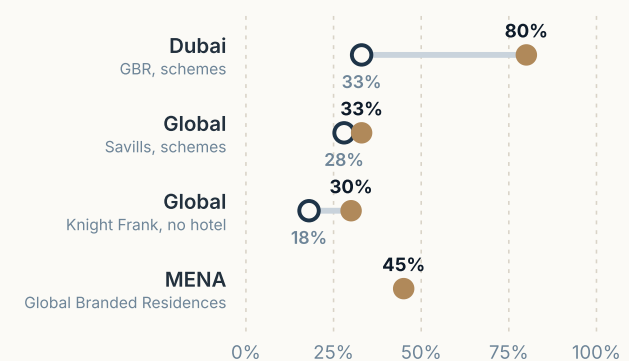
37%

of Dubai's USD 10m-plus apartment deals in 2024 went to OMNIYAT, by its own account, citing Property Monitor

EXHIBIT 13

Four-fifths of Dubai's branded pipeline has no hotel

Share of branded schemes that are standalone: completed (ring) and pipeline (dot)



Source: Global Branded Residences via Khaleej Times (Nov 2025) and Gulf Business (Oct 2025); Savills Annual Report 2025/2026; Knight Frank Global Branded Residence Survey 2025 (share not co-located with a hotel).

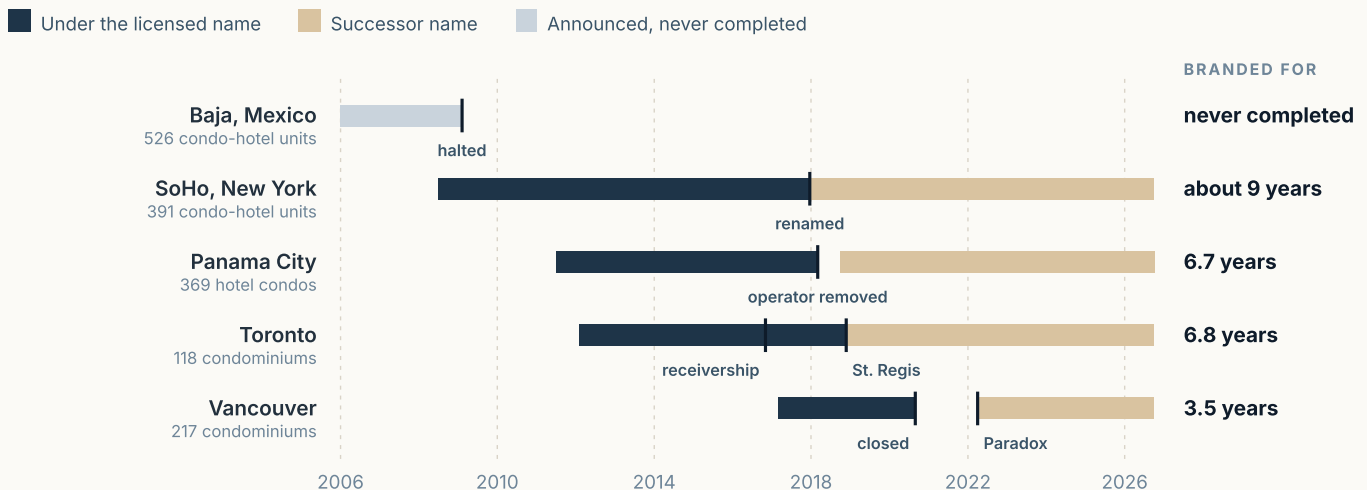
TENURE

Four of the five licensed hotel-condominium towers we traced lost the name within about ten years. The fifth was never completed.

EXHIBIT 14

A licensed name lasted between three and a half and about ten years

Five Trump-licensed hotel-condominium projects in the Americas: period under the licensed name, successor names and key events



Source: Wikipedia entries for St. Regis Toronto, The Dominick, JW Marriott Panama, Paradox Vancouver and Trump Ocean Resort Baja Mexico; Miller Thomson LLP (Apr 2025). **Heirstone analysis** for years under the name. Chosen because public records document each project's history; the record of one licensor, not a judgement on any current project.

A brand licence is a contract with an end date. Canadian counsel describe the residential licence as "typically limited and for a finite period of time". US counsel note that once a branded owners' association passes from the developer to the owners, the owners may be able to terminate or modify the brand management agreement. Some advise removing the brand name from condominium governing documents altogether because "nothing lasts forever".

One licensor's record shows how fast the name can go. Toronto opened in 2012, entered receivership in 2016 and became a St. Regis in 2018. In Panama, the hotel condominium owners' association removed the operator in 2018, seven years after

opening. Vancouver closed after the owner's bankruptcy filing three and a half years after opening and reopened under another name. In New York the name came off in 2017. The Baja project, a licensing arrangement, was halted before completion in 2009.

The name did not protect the lender either. The Toronto tower was sold in 2017 for about C\$298m, below the C\$310m of construction financing arranged in 2007.

Absorption can be slow even under established names. Of 375 Waldorf Astoria condominiums in New York, just over 30 had sold by late September 2025, about two months after the hotel reopened.

4 of 5

licensed hotel-condominium towers we traced lost the name; the fifth was never completed

30 of 375

Waldorf Astoria condominiums in New York sold by late September 2025

5

separate contracts a typical mixed-use branded scheme needs, according to US counsel

CHAPTER 5

05

Six tests for a brand that lasts

The first four chapters point to a small set of conditions under which a premium survives the first sale. We have turned them into six tests.

Two describe the product: how scarce it is and whether a hotel operates it. Two describe the evidence and the owner's costs. The last two cover the contract and the currency.

The grid sorts Dubai's evidence on the first two tests. The full test is on page 18, and the regional scorecard on page 26.

+37%

Bulgari Lighthouse, fewer than 40 homes beside a resort: 2022 average to a 2025 deal

-38%

Bugatti Residences, 182 homes and no hotel: median 2026 trade against the launch record

EXHIBIT 15

Four kinds of branded scheme, and how their prices have behaved

Heirstone typology on scheme size and hotel operation, with named examples and their price evidence (AED per sq ft)

HOTEL ON SITE

NO HOTEL ON SITE, OR NONE STATED

SMALL SCHEMES: UNDER 60 HOMES

SCARCE AND OPERATED

Resort trophy

Bulgari Lighthouse: fewer than 40 homes, with the Bulgari resort on the same island.

Armani Residences Diriyah: 15 homes beside a 70-room Armani hotel.

Price evidence: Bulgari Lighthouse AED 9,148 (2022) to 12,576 (2025), up 37%.

SCARCE, NAME ONLY

Collectible badge

Armani Beach Residences: 53 homes at launch.

Baccarat Residences: 49 homes.

ORLA Infinity: 20 duplexes; hotel not stated.

Price evidence: Armani Beach flat on its AED 8,000 launch; Baccarat AED 14,000 at launch, no trade found.

LARGE SCHEMES: OVER 150 HOMES

OPERATED, STRETCHED

Hotel annex

Six Senses The Palm: 172 homes and a 61-room hotel, 2.82 homes per room.

Marriott's Egyptian schemes: 870 homes against 610 rooms.

Price evidence: Six Senses Palm ready resales AED 4,867 to 7,243.

VOLUME, NAME ONLY

Licensed tower

Bugatti Residences: 182 homes.

Six Senses Dubai Marina: 251 homes in a 122-storey tower.

Dubai pipeline: 80% standalone; launches average about 460 homes.

Price evidence: Bugatti AED 3,105 to 11,259, median 5,962; Six Senses Marina AED 3,063 to 5,140.

Source: Heirstone Launch-to-Trade Register 2026; Heirstone Branded Residence Register 2026; Diriyah Company (Mar 2025); Marriott International (Jul 2026); Six Senses (Oct 2026); Morgan's International Realty (H1 2025). **Heirstone analysis.** Size thresholds are Heirstone judgements drawn from Exhibit 12.

The order of the evidence is consistent with the tests. The one scheme whose price rose sits in the top left corner. The widest spreads, and prices closest to the city's branded average, are in the bottom right, which is where most of Dubai's pipeline sits. The sample is small and the evidence mixes deals, trades and asking prices, so we use the grid to rank risk and leave valuation to registered trades.

THE HEIRSTONE BRAND DURABILITY TEST

Six questions to put to any branded scheme before paying for the name

Each test asks whether the premium is likely to be paid a second time. A scheme can pass all six and still launch at a modest premium; a scheme that fails several can still launch at a high one. The test is about what survives the first sale, and every threshold is tied to evidence in this report.

TEST	QUESTION	STRONG	WEAK	EVIDENCE BEHIND THE THRESHOLD
1 Scarcity	How many homes share the name, in this scheme and in this city?	Under 60 homes; the brand has few schemes in the city	Over 200 homes; the brand's city pipeline exceeds its open stock	Highest register prices from schemes of 20 to 53 homes; Dubai average 337, launches about 460; Mandarin Oriental 811 MENA homes announced against 156 open
2 Operation	Is there a working hotel on site, and how far is it stretched?	Hotel on site with no more than 1.5 homes per room	Standalone, or more than 2 homes per room	80% of Dubai's pipeline standalone; Six Senses Palm 2.82 and Kai Sokhna 2.15 homes per room; Armani Diriyah 0.21
3 Proof	Has completed branded stock in this city traded at resale?	Pipeline no more than 1.5 times completed stock, with registered resales	No completed stock, or a pipeline over five times completed	Dubai 1.36 times; Cairo 13 times; Ras Al Khaimah no completed scheme; 82% of Dubai branded deals off-plan
4 Carry	Does the matched premium clear the royalty and the extra running cost?	Matched premium above 20%; service charge under 1.5 times the neighbours	Matched premium below 16%, or service charge over twice the neighbours	Break-even 19.7%; luxury hotel brands 16%; villa communities below 10%; branded service charges 1.2 to 3.1 times
5 Tenure	Will the name outlast the developer?	Licence term, termination rights and successor arrangements disclosed at sale	Term not disclosed; owners can end the agreement with no successor; rental programme terms unclear	Four of five licensed towers traced lost the name; owners may end the agreement after handover (US counsel); licences are time-limited (Canadian counsel)
6 Currency	Are prices, costs and buyers' wealth in the same currency?	Single or pegged currency for price, cost and buyer	Prices in dollars, costs and buyers in a floating local currency	The pound lost 82% of its dollar value from 2016 to 2025; a USD 2bn Cairo scheme quoted at EGP 31.3bn converts to USD 0.64bn at the 2025 average rate

Source: Heirstone analysis. Thresholds are Heirstone judgements based on the evidence cited, which is drawn from Savills, Knight Frank, Morgan's International Realty, Marriott International, Mandarin Oriental, Six Senses, Diriyah Company, US and Canadian counsel and exchange-rate sources listed in the notes.

How to use it

Score the scheme strong, mixed or weak on each test. Scarcity and operation are fixed at the design stage and are the cheapest to get right. Proof comes only with time and completed stock. Carry and tenure sit in the contracts and the service-charge budget, and buyers rarely see either before they sign.

A scheme that scores strong on design and weak on proof may well achieve a high launch premium, as Cairo's first branded schemes may. What it cannot offer is evidence that the premium will be paid again.

How we would underwrite the gap

Where proof is weak, value the scheme at the matched premium of the nearest market with resale evidence, less the royalty and the capitalised service-charge uplift, and treat anything above that as upside to be earned. For a Dubai comparable that means about 10% of net value on a 30% premium, and nothing below a premium of about 20%.

Where tenure is weak, add a de-branding case: the scheme valued without the name, with the cost of a successor brand or of removing the old one.

CHAPTER 6



06

What the brand buys in the UAE, Egypt and Saudi Arabia

Dubai is a volume market with a public price record. Egypt has a long pipeline, almost no completed branded stock and a currency that lost 82% of its dollar value between 2016 and 2025. Saudi Arabia's foreign-ownership law took effect in 2026 for designated zones, and the branded schemes we could document are small, often villas, and mostly sponsored by state-owned developers.

The three markets share the brands and very little else. The brand does a different job in each, and the risk sits in a different place.

In Dubai the brand buys speed of sale in a crowded off-plan market. In Egypt it gives developers a hard-currency reference price in a market where more than 95% of Cairo buyers are local. In Saudi Arabia it gives first buyers an international operating standard in places with no resale market yet. The scorecard at the end of this chapter sets the regional schemes against the six tests.

THE HEIRSTONE BRANDED RESIDENCE REGISTER

Forty-nine named schemes across the region, and almost no published prices outside Dubai

EXHIBIT 16

Dubai holds 19 of the 49 schemes in the register; Egypt has 12

Named branded residence schemes in the Heirstone Branded Residence Register by location, October 2026 (Marrakech, one scheme, not shown)



Source: Heirstone Branded Residence Register 2026, compiled from brand residence directories (Four Seasons, Mandarin Oriental, Six Senses, Aman, Dorchester Collection), developer releases (Diriyah Company, Red Sea Global, OMNIYAT, Dar Global, Palm Hills, A Capital Holding, SODIC, LMD), Marriott International (Jul 2026) and the press. Locations are approximate district centroids; Greater Cairo includes New Cairo, West Cairo and the New Administrative Capital; Red Sea Global sites combine AMAALA (2) and Shura Island (1).

We compiled 49 named branded schemes in seven countries, recording brand, brand type, developer, homes, hotel rooms, status and any published price; Exhibit 17 lists the 30 outside Dubai. Dubai accounts for 19 and is the only city where we found registered trades. In Egypt and Saudi Arabia developers announce brands, unit counts and sometimes hotel keys. Service charges and resale data are not published, and the only prices we found are a portal asking price in West Cairo and Red Sea Global's SAR 5.5m entry price on Shura Island.

Scheme size differs sharply by market. Where a unit count is disclosed, Egyptian schemes average about 205 homes and Saudi schemes about 61, against 163 for the Dubai schemes in the register and 337 for Dubai's branded stock as a whole (Heirstone analysis). Saudi sponsors are building scarcity. Egyptian developers are building volume, mostly around hotels that have yet to open.

Counting is itself unsettled. Dubai's branded total is put at more than 50, 144, about 160, 166, 175 and 183 developments by different sources and at different dates in 2025 and 2026. Knight Frank counted 611 schemes worldwide in September 2025 and 903 at the end of 2025 in its next report. Global Branded Residences counts 201 UAE projects, 43 in Saudi Arabia and 32 in Egypt.

2

published prices for branded schemes outside Dubai: one portal asking price in Cairo and one starting price on Shura Island

205 / 61

average homes per Egyptian and per Saudi scheme with a disclosed count (Heirstone analysis)

0

published service charges found for any branded scheme outside Dubai

THE REGISTER OUTSIDE DUBAI

Thirty schemes outside Dubai, twelve of them in Egypt, and two published prices between them

EXHIBIT 17

Regional schemes publish a brand, a developer and usually a unit count, almost never a price

Heirstone Branded Residence Register 2026: named schemes outside Dubai, by market. Homes as disclosed; hotel on site as stated by the source; status at October 2026. All are hotel brands except Armani (fashion) and Trump (personal name). Dubai schemes and prices are in Exhibit 9.

SCHEME	DEVELOPER	HOMES	HOTEL ON SITE	STATUS	PUBLISHED PRICE
ABU DHABI: 4 SCHEMES					
Four Seasons Residences, Al Maryah Island	Mubadala	124	Yes	Opened 2016; sold out	
Four Seasons Residences, Saadiyat Beach	ALAIN	n/d	Not stated	Opening 2029	
Mandarin Oriental Mansions, Emirates Palace	n/v	35	Yes	Announced	
Mandarin Oriental, Saadiyat Cultural District	n/v	226	Not stated	Announced	
SAUDI ARABIA: 9 SCHEMES					
Armani Residences Diriyah	Diriyah Company	15	Yes, 70 rooms	Launched Mar 2025	
Aman Residences, Amansamar (Diriyah)	Diriyah Company	34 villas	Not stated	Coming soon	
The Chedi Residences, Wadi Safar (Diriyah)	Diriyah Company	20 villas	Not stated	Announced	
Four Seasons Residences, Jeddah Corniche	Midad Real Estate	76	Not stated	Opening 2027	
Mandarin Oriental Residences, Jeddah Central	n/v	187	Not stated	Announced	
Trump Tower Jeddah	Dar Global	n/d	Not stated	Launched	
Four Seasons Resort and Residences, AMAALA	Red Sea Global	26	Yes, resort	Opening 2025	
Six Senses Residences, Triple Bay, AMAALA	n/v	25	Not stated	Listed by brand	
Four Seasons Red Sea, Shura Island	Red Sea Global	75 + 31	Yes, resort	Opening 2025 or 2026	From SAR 5.5m*
EGYPT: 12 SCHEMES					
Ritz-Carlton Residences, Palm Hills (West Cairo)	Palm Hills Developments	150	Yes	Delivery Q4 2029	From EGP 132.5m (asking)
Marriott Residences Heliopolis	A Capital Holding	231	No; hotel services	Phase 1 handed over	
Four Seasons New Cairo Capital, Madinaty	Talaat Moustafa Group	187	Resort, 346 rooms	Opening 2027	
W Residences Cairo, One-Ninety (New Cairo)	LMD	300	Not stated	Announced	
Nobu residences, The Estates (New Zayed)	SODIC	n/d	Nobu hotel planned	Announced Aug 2023	
Luxury Collection Residences, The Hills of One	Misr Italia / P&P	180	Yes, 180 rooms	Signed Jul 2026	
Westin Residences, Il Bosco (New Capital)	Misr Italia Properties	n/d	Not stated	Signed 2022	
Ritz-Carlton Residences, The Med, Ras El Hekma	Misr Italia / P&P	268	Yes, 170 rooms	Signed Jul 2026	
Autograph Collection, Solare, Ras El Hekma	Misr Italia / P&P	250	Yes, 180 rooms	Signed Jul 2026	
Nobu hotel and residences, Ras El Hekma	SODIC	n/d	Nobu hotel planned	Announced Aug 2023	
Autograph Collection Residences, Kai Sokhna	Misr Italia / P&P	172	Yes, 80 rooms	Signed Jul 2026	
Four Seasons Residences, Sharm El Sheikh	Talaat Moustafa Group	103	Resort community	Opened 2002	
BAHRAIN, QATAR AND OMAN: 4 SCHEMES					
Four Seasons Residences, Bahrain Bay	Bay Side Developments	112	Adjacent hotel	Opening 2025	
Four Seasons Residences, The Pearl-Qatar	Q Bayraq	84	Not stated	Opening 2024	
The Residences at Mandarin Oriental, Muscat	Eagle Hills	156	Yes	Open	
Trump Golf and Cliff Villas, AIDA (Muscat)	Dar Global	n/d	Hotel in project	Listed by developer	
MOROCCO: 1 SCHEME					
Four Seasons Residences, Marrakech	Kingdom / DHC Maroc	43	Not stated	Sold out	

Source: Heirstone Branded Residence Register 2026, compiled from Four Seasons, Mandarin Oriental, Six Senses and Aman residence pages (accessed 4 Oct 2026); Diriyah Company (Mar 2025); Gulf Construction Online; Red Sea Global via Gulf Business (Feb 2025) and Arabian Business (2025); Dar Global (Oct 2026); Marriott International via Journal des Palaces (Jul 2026); Enterprise (May 2025); Invest-Gate; Egyptian Streets (Nov 2024); Hospitality Net (Aug 2023); Luxury Travel Advisor (Aug 2022); Property Finder Egypt (Oct 2026, portal asking price, grade C). n/d: not disclosed; n/v: not verified in a fetched source; P&P: People & Places. Shura Island: 75 villas and 31 resort residences; *the SAR 5.5m entry price covers the whole 126-home Red Sea Residences release. Heliopolis: 231 homes in the Signature Tower (2028), after 130 first-phase units.

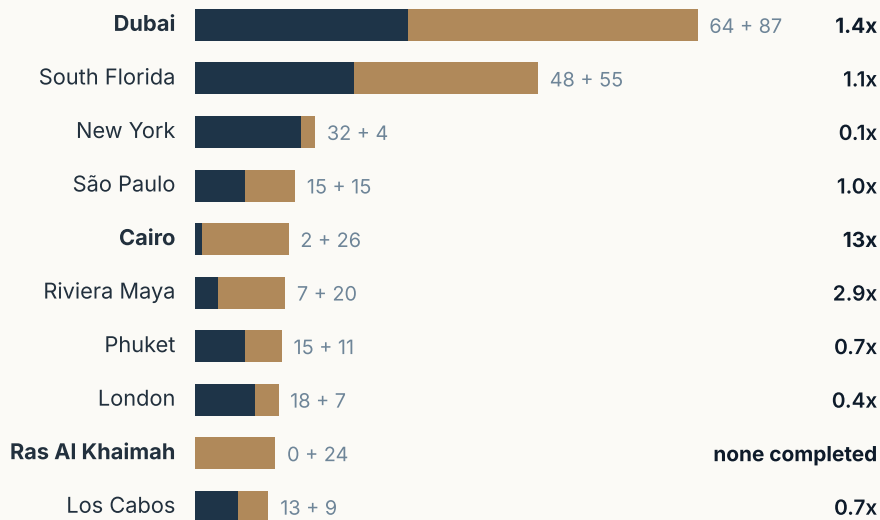
UNITED ARAB EMIRATES

Cairo and Ras Al Khaimah entered the global top ten almost entirely on pipeline

EXHIBIT 18

Dubai has a resale base; Cairo and Ras Al Khaimah have a pipeline

Savills' ten largest branded residence cities: completed (navy) and pipeline (gold) schemes, with pipeline as a multiple of completed, end 2025



Source: Savills, Branded Residences Annual Report 2025/2026 (Top 10 cities). Heirstone analysis for multiples.

Dubai has the region's only deep branded resale base: 64 completed schemes against 87 in the pipeline on Savills' count. It also faces the region's sharpest supply test, with branded stock up 34% in a year and four-fifths of its pipeline standalone. The wealth inflow is large but finite. Henley & Partners projected a net inflow of 9,800 millionaires to the UAE in 2025. Dubai launched 5,510 branded units in the first half of that year alone, about 11,000 at an annual rate. Not every buyer is a new arrival, but the comparison shows how quickly branded supply can catch up with the largest projected millionaire inflow of any country.

Abu Dhabi is smaller and newer. CBRE counts more than 2,700 branded units in over 20 projects, reports

1.36x

Dubai's branded pipeline against completed schemes, the lowest of the region's three top-ten cities

0 / 24

completed and pipeline branded schemes in Ras Al Khaimah

87%

CBRE's average branded premium in Abu Dhabi, 2025, on a method it does not detail

branded transaction volumes up 126% in 2025 and expects branded homes to make up 18% of the emirate's deliveries in 2029. Four Seasons' 124 homes on Al Maryah Island, opened in 2016, are sold out.

Ras Al Khaimah has 24 branded schemes in the pipeline and none completed. Knight Frank names Al Marjan Island the fastest-growing market in its top ten, at 45%, and CBRE expects branded units to make up 54% of the emirate's new supply by 2030; a separate report gives 25% of new freehold supply. According to Arabian Business, the Mondrian Al Marjan Island Beach Residences sold AED 704m of homes in two hours at launch. None of this can yet be checked against a resale.

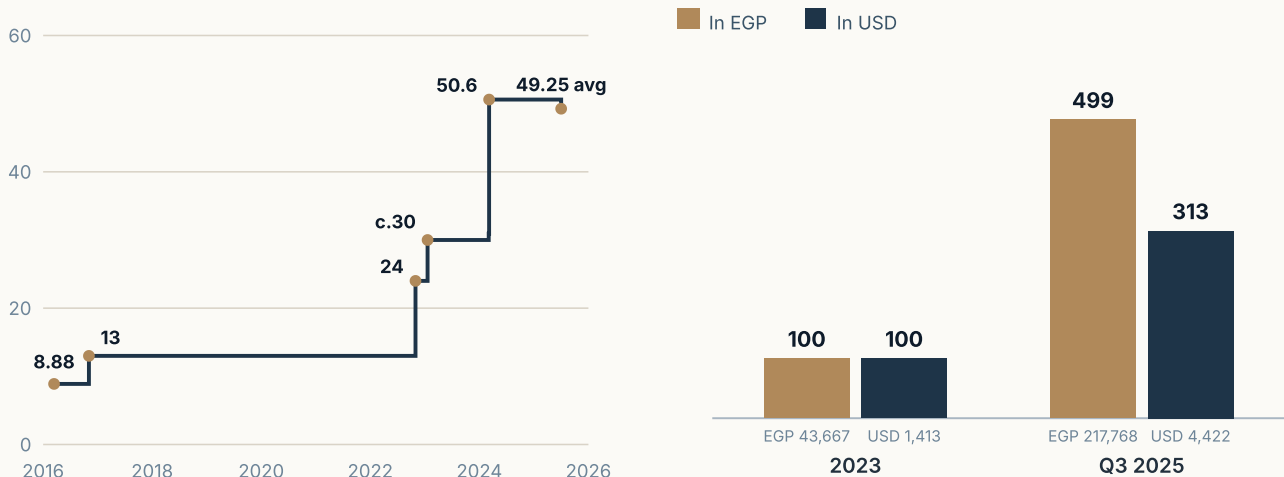
EGYPT

In dollars, Ras El Hekma prices roughly tripled between 2023 and 2025. In pounds they rose fivefold.

EXHIBIT 19

A pound-denominated boom looks smaller in dollars

Left: Egyptian pounds per US dollar, selected official and market points, 2016 to 2025. Right: Ras El Hekma average residential price per sqm, index 2023 = 100, in EGP and USD



Source: Egypt Independent; Peterson Institute (Aug 2024); AFP via Malay Mail (6 Mar 2024); exchange-rates.org (2025 average, grade C); JLL North Coast report via Zawya (2026). Heirstone analysis: USD values at EGP 30.9 (2023) and EGP 49.25 (2025 average). Jan 2023 rate approximate.

Several large Egyptian developers have signed international brands since 2022: Talaat Moustafa Group with Four Seasons at Madinaty in 2022, SODIC with Nobu in 2023, Palm Hills with The Ritz-Carlton in 2024, A Capital with Marriott in Heliopolis and, in July 2026, Misr Italia Properties and People & Places with Marriott for nine properties of more than 1,500 keys, about 55% of them residences, and more than EGP 56.7bn of investment. Four Seasons' two Egyptian schemes, both with Talaat Moustafa Group, hold 290 of the 910 homes on its published MENA residence pages, 32%, more than any other country (Heirstone analysis).

The pound lost about 82% of its dollar value between March 2016, at 8.88, and the 2025 average of 49.25. Developers responded by pricing in

dollars. In April 2023 several priced units in dollars and sold in pounds at 33 to 35 to the dollar, against an official rate near 30.9. JLL's North Coast data show how far the two measures diverge: Ras El Hekma rose from EGP 43,667 per sqm in 2023 to about EGP 217,768 in Q3 2025, five times higher in pounds and about 3.1 times in dollars (Heirstone analysis).

A brand helps a developer hold a dollar reference price. It also exposes schemes whose costs and prices sit in different currencies. According to Invest-Gate, W Residences Cairo was announced within a USD 2bn scheme quoted as EGP 31.3bn, an implied 15.65 pounds to the dollar. At the 2025 average rate the same pound figure converts to about USD 0.64bn.

82%

fall in the pound's dollar value, March 2016 to the 2025 average

32%

of Four Seasons' published MENA residences are in Egypt, at Madinaty and Sharm El Sheikh

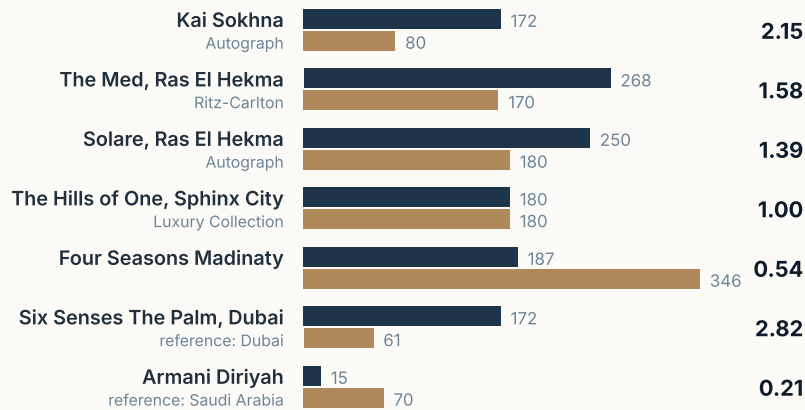
EGYPT

Egypt's new hotel-residence schemes plan more homes than hotel rooms

EXHIBIT 20

Marriott's Egyptian schemes have 1.43 homes for every hotel room

Branded residences (navy) and hotel rooms (gold) by scheme, with residences per room; Dubai and Saudi references



Source: Marriott International release via Journal des Palaces and Luxury Travel Advisor (Jul 2026); Four Seasons Madinaty (Aug 2022 announcement); Six Senses (Oct 2026); Diriyah Company (Mar 2025).
Heirstone analysis for ratios.

Marriott's four Egyptian schemes with residences in the July 2026 agreement have 870 homes against 610 hotel rooms. Kai Sokhna has 2.15 homes per room and The Med at Ras El Hekma 1.58 (Heirstone analysis). The ratio matters on a seasonal coast. JLL counts about 4,000 hotel keys on the North Coast, projected to reach about 6,700 by 2030, against a residential pipeline of about 126,600 units, 38% of them at Ras El Hekma. Where homes outnumber rooms, residential sales fund the hotel, and whether the hotel still runs to the brand's standard in year ten is likely to decide whether owners keep their premium.

Price evidence is thin. The only Egyptian branded price we found is an asking price: The Ritz-Carlton Residences at Palm Hills in West Cairo, listed on Property Finder Egypt from EGP 132.5m for a 375 sqm four-bedroom home, about EGP 353,000 per sqm. At the 2025 average rate that is about USD 7,170 per sqm, or USD 666 per sq ft, close to the USD 641 per sq ft Morgan's reports for

870 / 610

homes against hotel rooms across Marriott's four Egyptian residence schemes of July 2026

USD 666

per sq ft asking price at The Ritz-Carlton Residences, Palm Hills (Property Finder Egypt listing), at the 2025 average exchange rate

130

first-phase units handed over on time at Marriott Residences Heliopolis

comparable non-branded homes in Dubai, although one is an asking price and the other an average of sales. The asking price is 8.4 times the EGP 15.7m average unit sold by Egypt's ten largest developers in Q1 2025, as reported by Economy Middle East, and its rate per sqm is 18% above JLL's North Coast villa average (Heirstone analysis).

Most buyers are local: more than 95% of Cairo buyers, according to JLL. The rules for foreigners are loosening. Law 230 of 1996 limits a foreign owner to two residential properties; in July 2026 Al-Ahram Weekly reported that the cap had been lifted for purchases paid in foreign currency from abroad, while law firms still cited it in 2025. In the tourist zones named in a 2005 prime ministerial resolution, including Ras El Hekma, foreigners may hold freehold or usufruct of up to 99 years. A 2023 decree offers citizenship for USD 300,000 of state-owned property.

SAUDI ARABIA

Saudi Arabia's branded schemes are small, and its foreign-ownership law took effect only in 2026

EXHIBIT 21

The rules for foreign buyers took effect in 2026, after the first branded sales

Saudi Arabia: foreign ownership regime and branded residential supply, October 2026

Legal basis	Cabinet approved the law on 8 July 2025; in force from the start of 2026; implementing regulations approved 23 June 2026 and published in early July 2026
Where foreigners may buy	Riyadh: nine zones centred on giga-projects and transit-oriented development. Jeddah: city centre plus 55 development zones. Makkah: 11 designated developments. Madinah: 10
Taxes and fees	5% real estate transaction tax on every sale; 2% REGA fee when a non-Saudi disposes of a property right in Riyadh, Jeddah, Makkah or Madinah (0% for listed cases, including developer sales). An earlier press report of a combined 10% preceded the regulations
Before buying	Non-resident buyers need an Interior Ministry digital identity, a Saudi bank account and a Saudi phone number
Residency link	Premium Residency for property owners required property worth at least SAR 4m when the product was launched in January 2024, according to Argaam
Branded supply	Red Sea Residences: 126 homes from SAR 5.5m, 90 branded. Diriyah: about 300 branded residences across six brands; Armani 15 homes; Aman 34 villas; The Chedi 20 villas. Four Seasons Jeddah Corniche: 76 homes, opening 2027

Source: BCLP (Jul 2025); Greenberg Traurig (Jul 2026); Enterprise KSA (5 Jul 2026); Gulf News (Nov 2025); Argaam (10 Jan 2024); Gulf Business (Feb 2025); Arabian Business (2025); Diriyah Company (Mar 2025); Gulf Construction Online; Four Seasons (Oct 2026).

The Saudi schemes we documented look unlike Dubai's market. Most are small, tied to hotels and sponsored by state-owned developers. Diriyah's branded portfolio across six brands totals about 300 residences. Armani Residences Diriyah has 15 homes of 1,200 to 1,900 sqm beside a 70-room Armani hotel, 0.21 homes per room. Aman's Amansamar has 34 villas on plots from 9,000 sqm. Red Sea Global's Shura Island release had 126 homes from SAR 5.5m (USD 1.47m), 90 of them branded.

Early demand came before foreign ownership opened up: Red Sea Global sold more than one in eight Shura homes before the public launch in February 2025, five months before the foreign ownership law was approved. According to Arabian Business, AMAALA sold half its Nammos-branded apartments within two weeks of launch. Henley & Partners projected a net inflow of 2,400 millionaires to Saudi Arabia in 2025, a quarter of its UAE figure.

Private developers are taking a different route. Dar Global, listed in London, builds its model on more than 11 licensed brands, from Trump Organization and Aston Martin to Elie Saab and W, across a stated USD 23bn of development value in 14 cities and 9 countries. In Jeddah it has launched Trump Tower Jeddah, a scheme of about USD 530m according to Arabian Business. Such a developer is far more exposed to the brand premium than any of its brands is.

On the Brand Durability Test, Saudi schemes score well on scarcity and operation and weakly on proof. There is no branded resale market yet. A foreign owner selling in the four main cities pays the 2% REGA fee on top of the 5% transaction tax on the sale, Red Sea Residences' SAR 5.5m entry price is above the SAR 4m property value reported for the Premium Residency route at its launch.

0.21

homes per hotel room at Armani Residences Diriyah, against 2.82 at Six Senses The Palm

1 in 8

Shura Island homes sold before public launch

THE TEST APPLIED

How six kinds of regional scheme score on the Brand Durability Test

EXHIBIT 22

Only the boutique Dubai scheme scores strong on proof; outside Dubai the running costs are not published at all

Heirstone Brand Durability Test applied to six regional scheme types, with named examples

SCHEME TYPE	1 SCARCITY	2 OPERATION	3 PROOF	4 CARRY	5 TENURE	6 CURRENCY
Dubai: boutique, resort-anchored e.g. Bulgari Lighthouse	STRONG fewer than 40 homes	STRONG Bulgari resort on island	STRONG deals 2022 to 2025; +37%	MIXED Bulgari Residences AED 55; no neighbour benchmark	NO DATA terms not public	STRONG AED pegged
Dubai: large standalone tower e.g. Bugatti; Six Senses Marina	WEAK 182 to 251 homes; launches about 460	WEAK no hotel; 80% of pipeline	MIXED trades visible; 3.6x spread	MIXED charges 1.2 to 3.1 times	MIXED residential agreement only	STRONG AED pegged
Ras Al Khaimah: resort pipeline e.g. Al Marjan Island	MIXED branded 54% of new supply by 2030 (CBRE)	MIXED resort hotels planned	WEAK no completed scheme	NO DATA not published	NO DATA terms not public	STRONG AED pegged
Egypt: North Coast hotel-residence e.g. The Med; Solare	MIXED 250 to 268 homes	MIXED hotel on site; 1.4 to 1.6 homes per room	WEAK no branded resale data	NO DATA not published	NO DATA terms not public	MIXED dollar reference price, pound market
Egypt: Cairo urban schemes e.g. East and West Cairo towers	MIXED 150 to 300 homes per scheme	MIXED some with hotel alongside	WEAK Cairo pipeline 13 times completed	NO DATA not published	NO DATA terms not public	WEAK over 95% local buyers; floating pound
Saudi Arabia: giga-project villas e.g. Armani Diriyah; Amansamar; Shura	STRONG 15 to 75 homes per brand	STRONG 0.21 homes per room at Armani	WEAK no resale market; foreign buyers from 2026	NO DATA not published	MIXED state-owned sponsors; terms not public	STRONG riyal pegged

Source: Heirstone analysis, based on evidence in Chapters 1 to 6: Savills (2025/2026); Morgan's International Realty; CBRE (Dec 2025); Marriott International (Jul 2026); Diriyah Company (Mar 2025); Red Sea Global via Gulf Business (Feb 2025); JLL via Enterprise and Zawya; exchange-rate sources. Scores are Heirstone judgements on public information and do not assess any individual developer.

Reading the scorecard

The only scheme type with a strong score on proof is the small, resort-anchored Dubai tower, and it is also the rarest. Dubai's large standalone towers, which make up most of the city's pipeline, score weakly on the two design tests that a developer controls.

The Saudi villa schemes are the mirror image. They score well on everything that can be fixed at the design stage and weakly on what only time provides: a resale market and a record of operation.

Where the risk sits

Cairo's urban schemes score weakest on this test. They are mid-sized, not always operated by a hotel on site, priced against a floating currency and sold into a city with 26 branded schemes in the pipeline for 2 completed. A buyer there is paying for a premium that nobody has yet observed at resale.

Carry is the blank column. Outside Dubai we found no published service charge for any branded scheme in the region.

CHAPTER 7

07

What each party should do

Each recommendation follows from evidence in this report. Most cost little to adopt; several only need information that already exists to be published.

GOVERNMENTS, LAND AGENCIES AND
REGULATORS

- 1 Publish a branded resale series.**

The Dubai Land Department already registers each trade. Flagging branded projects in its open data would let buyers compare launch prices with resale prices scheme by scheme. Egypt and Saudi Arabia, which have no branded resale data, can build the flag into registration from the first sale.
- 2 Make the brand's terms part of the sale.**

Require disclosure of the licence term, who can end it, any successor arrangement, the rental programme's terms and a service-charge budget with brand-related costs shown separately. Canadian counsel already advise keeping the brand name out of condominium governing documents because the agreements behind it can end.
- 3 Tie residential sales to hotel delivery where homes outnumber rooms.**

Marriott's four Egyptian residence schemes have 870 homes against 610 rooms, and Kai Sokhna 2.15 homes per room. Phasing land payments or sales releases to hotel milestones protects buyers who are paying for the hotel's presence.
- 4 Settle the rules foreign branded buyers rely on.**

Egypt's reported 2026 easing for purchases paid in foreign currency sits beside a two-property cap still cited by law firms. In Saudi Arabia, an early press report of a combined 10% in fees differed from the 2% fee and 5% tax in the published regulations. Clear published rules reduce the premium buyers attach to uncertainty.

MASTER DEVELOPERS

- 1 Underwrite at the premium against comparable homes.**

Use a premium of about 30%, in line with Savills' matched and city-average figures, test it against the 19.7% break-even, and treat the gap between that and Dubai's 56% headline as location already paid for in the land.
- 2 Keep branded schemes small, or split them.**

The highest prices in our register came from schemes of 20 to 53 homes; Dubai's average branded scheme has 337 and recent launches about 460. Two smaller branded buildings carry more scarcity than one large one.
- 3 Share the downside with the brand.**

A royalty on the gross price takes 24% of a 30% premium and 60% of a 10% one. A lower base royalty with a share of the premium achieved, or a term that runs beyond handover, aligns the brand with the owner.
- 4 Price in the currency of your costs and your buyers.**

In Egypt, quote in dollars only where costs and buyers are dollar-based. A USD 2bn scheme quoted at EGP 15.65 to the dollar converts to USD 0.64bn at 2025 rates.

INVESTORS AND LENDERS

1 Value on registered trades, not launch records.

In the register, the launch record described the best unit; Bugatti's median trade was 38% below it. Lend against matched resale evidence and haircut launch prices accordingly.

2 Underwrite net yield.

On reported Downtown yields and our central-case prices a branded unit nets about 4.4% against 5.3%. A hotel pool keeping 30 to 45% of revenue must lift gross rent by 43 to 82% to match an annual let.

3 Price a de-branding case.

Four of the five licensed towers we traced lost the name, and the Toronto tower was later sold for less than its construction financing. Covenants should cover licence termination, rebranding cost and service standards.

4 Discount pipeline-only markets.

Cairo (2 completed, 26 pipeline) and Ras Al Khaimah (none and 24) have no branded resale base, and Savills finds emerging-city premiums 57% more variable than established ones.

BRANDS AND OPERATORS

1 Write succession into the contract.

Toronto, Panama and Vancouver each lost the licensed name within seven years of opening. A residential management agreement that sets out how a successor brand is appointed, and at whose cost, protects owners and the brand's own standing.

2 Ration the name by city.

Mandarin Oriental has 811 MENA homes announced against 156 open. Dorchester Collection lists eight Dubai residential schemes against two in London. A published cap per city protects earlier buyers' premiums.

3 Publish the running costs.

Outside Dubai we found no published service charge for any branded scheme. A brand that publishes its service standards and charge benchmarks makes its premium easier to underwrite.

BEFORE SIGNING A BRANDED PURCHASE

Ask for the registered resale prices of the brand's completed schemes in the city. Ask for the service-charge budget and the share that pays for brand services. Ask how long the licence runs, who can end it and what happens to the name if it ends. Ask how many homes share the brand in the city, today and in the pipeline. Then compare the premium with the 20% the brand needs just to pay for itself.

THE NUMBERS TO UNDERWRITE

UNDERWRITING BENCHMARK	VALUE	BASIS
Premium against comparable homes	29 to 30%	Savills, Dubai 2020 (matched) and cities 2025
Break-even premium	19.7% (11 to 27%)	Heirstone analysis, Exhibits 5 to 8
Royalty on the sale price	5 to 6% (1 to 6%)	Marriott; US and Canadian counsel
Service charge against neighbours	1.2 to 3.1 times	Dubai broker compilations
Net yield, branded against unbranded	4.4% against 5.3%	Downtown Dubai midpoints, Heirstone analysis
Operator share of a hotel rental pool	30 to 45% of gross rent	Downtown Dubai, Oliva
Pipeline against completed schemes	Dubai 1.36; Cairo 13; RAK none completed	Savills, end 2025

Sources as cited in Chapters 1 to 6; broker figures are indicative.

How Heirstone works on branded and specialised residential

We help landowners, developers and investors decide whether a brand belongs in a scheme and what it is worth: market and demand studies, highest and best use, matched-premium and resale analysis, feasibility modelling (DCF, IRR, NPV and Monte Carlo testing), and the commercial terms of brand, hotel and residential agreements, across the Middle East and Africa.

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NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

Notes

Definitions

Branded residence: a home sold or managed under a licensed brand, with or without a hotel on site. **Standalone:** a branded residential scheme with no hotel on site. **Matched premium:** the price premium against a sample of comparable unbranded homes in the same market. **Unmatched premium:** a branded average divided by an average for the wider market. **Off-plan:** sold before completion. **Residences per room:** branded homes divided by hotel rooms in the same scheme. **Break-even premium:** the premium at which the royalty and the capitalised service-charge uplift equal the premium. Prices are in AED per sq ft as published (1 USD = 3.6725 AED); sources do not always state the area basis.

Method

The ledger and break-even premium (Exhibits 5 to 8) use an unbranded comparable of AED 2,354 per sq ft (Morgan's, H1 2026); a 30% premium (Savills' 2025 city average, close to its matched 29% for Dubai in 2020); a royalty of 5.5% of the branded price (Marriott's stated 5 to 6%); a service-charge uplift of AED 20 per sq ft a year from broker compilations for Downtown Dubai; capitalisation at 6.5%, the midpoint of reported unbranded Downtown gross yields (a Heirstone assumption); and gross yields of 6.0% branded and 6.5% unbranded (midpoints of a single adviser's ranges). Higher build, amenity, marketing and sales costs and taxes are excluded because none is published. The Launch-to-Trade Register uses DLD-registered trades as republished by Property Finder (accessed 4 October 2026), developer releases and the press. The Branded Residence Register lists 49 named schemes in seven countries compiled in October 2026; coordinates are approximate. Egyptian dollar values use EGP 30.9 for 2023 (the official rate before the March 2024 float) and EGP 49.25, the 2025 average. Where sources conflict we show both or use the more conservative figure.

Where sources conflict

Dubai branded stock at end-2025 is 59,560 units in 175 developments (Morgan's) or 51,000+ in 166 (Khaleej Times, research not named); we use Morgan's throughout. Armani Beach Residences had 53 homes at launch and 57 in a 2026 report; we use 53. Bulgari Lighthouse's AED 410m penthouse is about AED 10,513 per sq ft on the reported 39,000 sq ft and AED 13,543 in a later report; we plot the lower figure. Atlantis The Royal Residences were put at AED 4,310 (Knight Frank) or 6,490 (Property Finder) for 2022; both are shown. Burj Khalifa's service charge is AED 42, 60 or 67.88 depending on the broker, and Armani Residences' AED 80 (fām) or 70 to 95 (Oliva); we compare Armani's 80 with the 60 from the same source. Dubai's 2025 off-plan share is 69% of sales by volume (fām Properties) or 73% (Cavendish Maxwell). Ras Al Khaimah's branded share of new supply is 54% (CBRE) or 25% of freehold supply (Khaleej Times). The Saudi property-owner residency threshold is reported at SAR 4m (Argaam, at launch in 2024) and above SAR 5m in a later press report; we use the launch figure. Egypt's two-property cap for foreigners is still cited by law firms but was reported lifted in 2026 for purchases paid in foreign currency from abroad. The 40 to 60% premium range for H1 2025 appears in Khaleej Times without a named issuer, and we label it so.

Sources by chapter

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CHAPTER 4

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CHAPTERS 5 AND 6

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